



NERVES



Nerve network

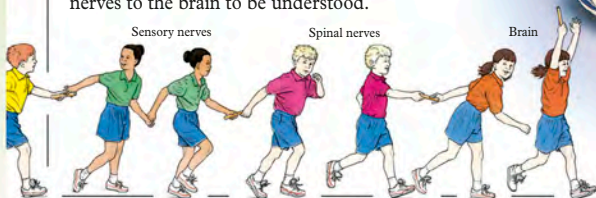


Reading by touch

Blind people cannot see to read, so they learn a special alphabet of raised dots, called braille. They feel these dots with their fingertips.

Get the message?

Messages about how objects feel are sent through the sensory nerves and the spinal nerves to the brain to be understood.



Sensory nerves

Spinal nerves

Brain

Nerves are like telephone wires carrying information between the brain and all parts of the body. One set of nerves—the sensory nerves—carries signals to your brain from your senses, telling your brain what is happening around you. When your brain has decided what to do, it sends signals along another set of nerves—the motor nerves—to make your muscles work.

What's on the "feely table?"

The sense of touch is very important. It is one of your five senses. Receptor cells under your skin send messages, through sensory nerves, to your brain about what your fingers are feeling.

A bottle feels hard and smooth.



If you touch some honey, your fingers will feel that it is sticky.



Ice is cold and slippery. When it starts to melt it feels wet.



Speedy reflex

If someone claps their hands by your face, your brain thinks something is flying toward your eyes and they blink. This blink is a reflex action to protect them.

With your eyes covered, can you tell it is a teddy bear?

